



Providing Creative Solutions to Common Problems

EMS & MUNICIPAL RECOVERY · CAPABILITIES OVERVIEW

Debt Collection Agency for Businesses

Recovering unpaid ambulance-transport, utility and fine balances for the City of Pompano Beach — on pure contingency

Prepared for **City of Pompano Beach** · July 2026

Turning uncollected EMS transport and non-tax revenue back into budget

Prepared for the City of Pompano Beach — Fire Rescue has run its own EMS transport 24/7 since 1975 across seven stations, and a coastal city treats and transports as many visitors as residents. Every transport is a bill, and the patient-responsibility balances left after insurance — especially for out-of-town patients — are among the hardest a city ever collects. Add delinquent utilities, code-enforcement fines, parking and permit fees, and the uncollected non-tax book adds up fast.

EMS transport is the marquee bleed. The city bills every ambulance transport through its patient portal, but a large share of patient responsibility after insurance goes unpaid — and visitors transported to the hospital leave with a balance and no local address. Those, plus delinquent utilities, fines and fees, accumulate quietly in an aging report and get written off.

Southwest Recovery Services recovers exactly this — patient EMS balances, delinquent utilities, code and permit fees — on pure contingency since 2004, worked the way a public-sector creditor should be represented: firm, professional, documented, and transparent enough to defend at a public meeting. EMS patient accounts run under HIPAA and the FDCPA. No recovery, no fee — no budget line to defend.

Two decades of recovery — built for public-sector constraints

The recovery capacity a city can add without headcount, cost, or risk to constituent relationships — documented, compliant, and paid only on results.

2004 Recovering commercial receivables since	\$975M+ Receivables placed (all industries)	\$76M+ Recovered for clients	800K+ Accounts worked
52% of placed accounts see a recovery	50 states — nationwide recovery reach	4.9★ Google client rating	\$0 upfront — no recovery, no fee

Commercial & B2B collections since 2004

Nationwide — all 50 states

12 offices across 7 states

Skip tracing on businesses & principals

Contingency — no recovery, no fee

RECOGNIZED & FEATURED BY

[USA Today](#) [Financial Services Review — Top AR Management Service 2025](#)

[insideARM — 10× ROI](#) [CFO Tech Outlook — Top 10](#) [International Business Times](#)

ACCREDITED & RECOGNIZED



What a city finance office asks us

The questions that matter when the creditor is a public entity.

YOUR QUESTION	SOUTHWEST RECOVERY SERVICES
Fee structure	Pure contingency — \$0 upfront, no retainer, no minimum, no new budget line. You pay a percentage only of what we actually recover, so recovered EMS and non-tax revenue is net-new money to the general fund.
What we recover	Unpaid EMS / ambulance-transport balances (patient responsibility after insurance), delinquent water / sewer / solid-waste accounts, code-enforcement and administrative fines, parking citations, permit / inspection / business-license fees, false-alarm fees, returned checks and special assessments — any overdue balance owed to the city.
EMS transport & out-of-town patients	A beach city transports many non-residents; those patients leave with a balance and no local address, and the patient-responsibility portion after insurance often goes unworked. We skip-trace the responsible party nationwide and pursue insurance follow-up, so transport revenue isn't lost to distance.
Public accountability & compliance	We work every account in firm, professional language consistent with how a public-sector creditor should be represented — no harassment, no threats, nothing that creates liability — documented thoroughly enough to defend at a public meeting or under an open-records request.
Which rules apply	EMS patient balances are consumer debt handled under HIPAA and the FDCPA / Regulation F; resident utility, parking and court-cost balances under the FDCPA / Reg F; business and inter-governmental balances as commercial debt. We apply each framework to the right account and report under the FCRA.
How we recover	Nationwide skip tracing to locate transported visitors and residents who've moved (the biggest obstacle on EMS and closed-utility balances), insurance follow-up, structured payment plans, credit-bureau reporting, and pre-legal / legal escalation — including liens or tax-roll certification where the balance and Florida statute allow.
Onboarding & aged sweep	Your fire-rescue billing or finance team uploads an aging export through our secure portal; we map your columns, no re-keying, and outreach begins within 24 hours. Place current delinquencies and a one-time sweep of aged EMS and utility balances together — on contingency there's no cost to placing old accounts.

Low-lift intake and full, auditable visibility

Every placement runs through our secure portal — built to take your finance / utility-billing exports and give your team live, documented status throughout recovery, backed by a dedicated account manager.

SYSTEM-READY PLACEMENT

Upload an aging export from your utility-billing or finance system (CSV/Excel) — we map your columns, no re-keying.

REAL-TIME, AUDITABLE REPORTING

Run and export account and recovery reports on demand — a documented trail you can defend publicly.

SECURE FILE EXCHANGE

Send account records and supporting documents safely inside the portal, not over email — important for open-records discipline.

DIRECT-PAYMENT REPORTING

Log payments a resident makes directly to the city, so balances stay accurate and no one is over-contacted.

► **Portal Video Tour**

SWRS Government & Municipal Recovery Case Studies

Actual placed-versus-recovered results from Southwest Recovery's public-sector book, anonymized by category. Aged municipal non-tax debt recovers modestly — but at zero cost to place, every recovered dollar is net-new budget.

MUNICIPAL FIRE & EMS

Ambulance transport fees

\$38K recovered

of ~\$567K placed

7% recovered

REGIONAL WATER UTILITY

Water supply authority

\$193K recovered

of ~\$350K placed

55% recovered

COUNTY SERVICES

Property & services billing

\$20K recovered

of ~\$106K placed

19% recovered

SPECIAL DISTRICT

Parks / recreation district

\$49K recovered

of ~\$453K placed

11% recovered

COUNTY SOLID WASTE

Sanitation billing

\$18K recovered

of ~\$241K placed

7% recovered

MUNICIPAL UTILITY BILLING

Water / sewer accounts

\$15K recovered

of ~\$491K placed

3% recovered

Anonymized by sector from Southwest Recovery's book; individual client names withheld. Results vary by account age, balance, documentation quality and industry. We do not publish blended portfolio averages.

WHY PLACE AGED MUNICIPAL DEBT

At zero cost to place, recovery is pure upside

Municipal non-tax debt is usually left to age because working it costs staff time the city doesn't have — so it sits, then it's written off. Contingency changes that calculus entirely.

NO DOWNSIDE

On no-recovery-no-fee terms, placing an aged utility or EMS balance costs nothing; whatever comes back is net-new general-fund revenue.

PLACE EARLY, RECOVER MORE

Fresh balances recover far better than aged ones — a standing placement cadence on newly-delinquent accounts lifts the whole book over time.

We speak your constraints

A city's receivables carry obligations a private creditor's don't. Our process is built for them.



EMS transport recovery

Recovering unpaid ambulance-transport balances — including out-of-town patients — through nationwide skip tracing and insurance follow-up, under HIPAA and the FDCPA.



Public-accountability compliance

Firm, professional, fully documented conduct you could defend at a public meeting — FDCPA / Reg F on resident accounts, FCRA on reporting.



Constituent-relationship protection

Residents are taxpayers and voters; we recover respectfully and lawfully, protecting the city's standing while returning revenue.



No budget burden

Pure contingency — no upfront cost, no new line item; recovered non-tax revenue is net-new to the general fund.

Recovery run on an AI-driven platform — Aktos

Every account SWRS works runs on Aktos, a next-generation, AI-driven collections platform — with compliance built into the workflow, not bolted on afterward. It's how a boutique, people-first agency delivers enterprise-grade speed, consistency, and auditability.



AI workflow automation

Repetitive steps are automated and every account is scored and routed by predicted payment likelihood — so the right strategy reaches the right account first, without manual queue-picking.



Omnichannel outreach

Coordinated email, SMS, and voice, timed to when a debtor is most likely to engage — replacing high-friction call blasts with respectful, data-driven contact.



Compliance built in

FDCPA, Reg F, and TCPA guardrails are enforced inside the automation, with phone-number and consent checks before outreach — documented and defensible on every account.



Real-time dashboards

You see status, segmentation, and recovery performance on your portfolio in real time — full transparency, not a monthly PDF.



API-first intake

Secure SFTP/API placement means accounts start working without data lag — roughly 50% faster acknowledgment and validation of new placements.



Data-driven scoring

Dynamic scoring and segmentation predict payment likelihood and concentrate effort where recovery is most achievable — earlier intervention that trims DSO and reduces disputes.

The result is the combination clients rarely get from a legacy agency: faster cash and cleaner compliance at the same time. Automation accelerates recovery and standardizes documentation, while empathy-first, data-driven contact protects your brand and keeps disputes and complaints low.

Built by a collector with 30 years on the phones — not a CEO with zero collection experience



Steven Dietz

Founder & Chief Executive Officer

Featured in USA Today, International Business Times & Financial Services Review — Top AR Management Service, 2025 · ACA International member.

Steven Dietz didn't come to collections from the corner office — he came from the phones. He started as a collector and credit analyst before he was 20, was tapped by Aaron's to train collectors across 100+ locations, and has spent nearly 30 years in receivables. Along the way he became convinced the industry's bad reputation was a choice, not a requirement: businesses get paid faster when recovery is built on listening and respect rather than aggressive calls and empty threats.

He founded Southwest Recovery Services in 2004 on that principle — a national, family-owned receivables partner that treats every debtor as a person and every client relationship as worth protecting. Two decades later he still coaches the teams and works accounts personally — an operator who has actually done the job, not a manager who has only overseen it.

“Regardless of the means of recovery, our focus is always on preserving goodwill and representing the client professionally.”

— Steven Dietz, Founder & Chief Executive Officer, Southwest Recovery Services

For a public entity, how a debt is pursued matters as much as whether it's recovered. We represent the City of Pompano Beach the way a public-sector creditor

should be — firm, professional, and fully documented
— so the city recovers revenue while protecting the
constituent relationships and public trust it depends
on.

Take it with you

Download this overview and the supporting white papers to share with your team.



Capabilities overview

PDF · prepared for City of
Pompano Beach

[Download PDF ↓](#)



Recovering Municipal Receivables

Non-tax revenue · PDF

[Download PDF ↓](#)



The Recovery Waterfall

Our collection process · PDF

[Download PDF ↓](#)



The Experian Intelligence Advantage

Data-first recovery · PDF

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The Aktos Advantage

AI-powered collections · PDF

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The Placement-File Standard

Maximizing recovery · PDF

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Let's put a number on your unbilled EMS and non-tax revenue.

A 30-minute call to walk your unpaid ambulance-transport, utility, fine and fee balances and put a contingency rate against a representative sample — no cost, and no budget line to defend.

[Book a 30-minute discovery call →](#)

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12 offices across 7 states · nationwide recovery. Private & confidential — prepared for City of Pompano Beach. FDCPA / CFPB / FCRA compliant · ACA International member.